

access any data provided by the view. Because our view for the home page provides no data, this template is fairly simple.

Inside the *learning_logs* folder, make a new folder called *templates*. Inside the *templates* folder, make another folder called *learning_logs*. This might seem a little redundant (we have a folder named *learning_logs* inside a folder named *templates* inside a folder named *learning_logs*), but it sets up a structure that Django can interpret unambiguously, even in the context of a large project containing many individual apps. Inside the inner *learning_logs* folder, make a new file called *index.html*. The path to the file will be *ll_project/learning_logs/templates/learning_logs/index.html*. Enter the following code into that file:

index.html <p>Learning Log</p>

<p>Learning Log helps you keep track of your learning, for any topic you're interested in.</p>

This is a very simple file. If you're not familiar with HTML, the <p></p> tags signify paragraphs. The <p> tag opens a paragraph, and the </p> tag closes a paragraph. We have two paragraphs: the first acts as a title, and the second describes what users can do with Learning Log.

Now when you request the project's base URL, *http://localhost:8000/*, you should see the page we just built instead of the default Django page. Django will take the requested URL, and that URL will match the pattern ''; then Django will call the function *views.index()*, which will render the page using the template contained in *index.html*. Figure 18-3 shows the resulting page.

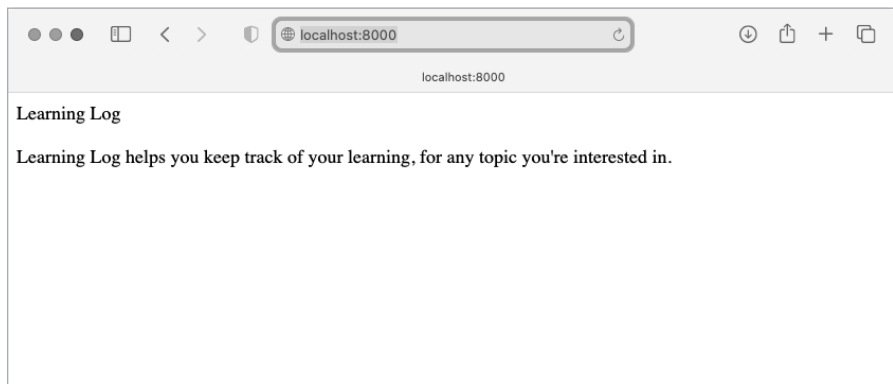


Figure 18-3: The home page for Learning Log

Although it might seem like a complicated process for creating one page, this separation between URLs, views, and templates works quite well. It allows you to think about each aspect of a project separately. In larger projects, it allows individuals working on the project to focus on the areas in which they're strongest. For example, a database specialist can focus on the models, a programmer can focus on the view code, and a frontend specialist can focus on the templates.